Dr. Vishwanath Karad MIT WORLD PEACE UNIVERSITY | PUNE — Since 1983

Ignisia — Think Build Evolve

Ignisia Club @ **Dr. Vishwanath Karad MIT World Peace University** presents

INCUBEX

2026

From Vision To Venture

A National-Level Tech Launchpad by *Ignisia*

Register Now → | Upload presentation | Explore Tracks ↓

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21 OCT 2026

GRAND FINALE
21 October 2026
On campus, full day

VENUE
MIT-WPU Campus
Kothrud, Maharashtra

PRIZE POOL
₹50,000+
Diploma, UG & PG · across India

IN ASSOCIATION WITH

IET The Institution of Engineering and Technology | IEEE MIT-WPU STUDENT BRANCH | INSTITUTION'S INNOVATION COUNCIL | ISTE

OUR SPONSORS

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THE HOSTS

Who we are

ABOUT MIT-WPU

Dr. Vishwanath Karad MIT World Peace University

1983
Building excellence since

Dr. Vishwanath Karad MIT World Peace University (MIT-WPU) is one of India's most distinguished institutions dedicated to academic excellence, innovation, and value-based education since 1983. Located in Kothrud, the university has grown into a vibrant educational hub offering diverse undergraduate, postgraduate, and doctoral programs across engineering, management, science, design, law, and liberal arts. Built on the unique philosophy of integrating science, technology, and spiritual values, MIT-WPU nurtures responsible professionals who contribute meaningfully to society and global progress.

Engineering is one of the university's strongest academic pillars, with specialised programs in Computer Engineering, Artificial Intelligence & Data Science, Mechanical, Civil, Electronics & Communication, and Robotics. Advanced laboratories, innovation and research centres, and product-based learning environments give students strong technical foundations and practical industry exposure — and through hackathons, research initiatives, industry collaborations, and entrepreneurship support, MIT-WPU's ecosystem empowers students to become future-ready engineers.

Engineering | AI & Data Science | Robotics | Research centres | Entrepreneurship support

ABOUT IGNISIA CLUB

Ignisia is a student-led club at MIT-WPU focused on fostering innovation, technical learning, and collaboration. It creates opportunities for students to explore emerging technologies, work on practical problems, and showcase their ideas on a larger platform.

Ignisia previously organised a national-level AI Hackathon with **1,600+ students** from across India, building AI solutions for real-world and social-impact challenges. Building on that, the club now aims to bring MIT-WPU and its students onto a national platform — strengthening technical skills, AI research, and an entrepreneurial mindset. Through initiatives such as INCUBEX 2026, Ignisia is building a stronger culture of innovation, research, collaboration, and product development.

CLUB GOAL

Think.
Build.
Evolve.

1,600+
students in Ignisia's national-level AI Hackathon

ABOUT THE SUMMIT

About INCUBEX 2026

INCUBEX 2026 is Ignisia Club's national-level deep tech summit at MIT-WPU — a platform that bridges the gap between student innovation and real-world impact, helping convert student products into working prototypes and, eventually, into products.

Not a traditional hackathon

INCUBEX is an expo-style summit where student teams present their products — academic builds, functional models, or operational ventures — to expert panels in a structured evaluation environment. Selected teams gain direct access to incubation programs, investor pitching channels, and mentorship networks.

Hybrid format

Online screening rounds, followed by an offline **Grand Finale on 21st October 2026** at the MIT-WPU campus. The event brings together student innovators, industry experts, mentors, and potential investors to evaluate, refine, and connect student concepts with growth opportunities.

KEY OBJECTIVES

01 Offer a national stage for students to present working prototypes and products.

02 Encourage practical problem-solving across key domains like AI, hardware, sustainability, and healthcare.

03 Connect student teams with industry mentors, feedback, and potential incubation or investment channels.

04 Strengthen ties between MIT-WPU, academic institutions, and the broader product ecosystem.

WHO CAN TAKE PART

Participants

ELIGIBILITY

Diploma, UG & PG

College students from institutions across India, any branch or stream. School students are not eligible.

TEAMS

1 — 6 members

Both tracks. Solo participation allowed. All members from the same college.

FINALISTS

80 teams

30 Product Track + 50 Prototype Expo Track teams shortlisted for the on-campus Grand Finale.

⚠ **A functional working product or prototype is mandatory for the Grand Finale** — purely theoretical concepts or slide-only presentations are not eligible.

WHY TAKE PART

Honours & Perks

Every finalist leaves with more than a certificate — a path from the expo floor to investors, incubators, and mentors.



₹50,000+

Prize Pool

Plus consolation prize vouchers and credits.

Incubation Support

Fast-track incubation at MIT-WPU Innovation Centres & Technology Business Incubator.

Investor Pitch

Direct pitch access to an angel & VC panel for seed funding and acceleration support.

Trophies

Category laurels for 1st, 2nd and 3rd place winners.

Certificates

For all participants — digital participation certificates for every member.

Mentorship

Guidance from industry leaders, mentorship networks, and technical credits.

PRIZES BY TRACK

PRODUCT TRACK

Top-performing startups receive **direct pitch access** to angel investors, venture funds, and ecosystem partners for seed funding, equity investment, and acceleration support — plus **direct entry or fast-tracked screening** for incubation programs at partner hubs and MIT-WPU Innovation Centres.

PROTOTYPE EXPO

- **Cash prizes, trophies & certificates** for 1st, 2nd and 3rd place.
- **3 consolation prizes** for standout technical builds and high-potential products.

ALL PARTICIPANTS

- Participation certificates for all shortlisted Grand Finale teams.
- Select teams across both tracks gain access to mentorship networks, technical credits, and industry guidance.

AFTER THE FINALE

Incubation, Seed Support & *Network Access*

Winners and standout projects receive fast-track incubation support at the MIT-WPU Technology Business Incubator (TBI), direct investor syndicate introductions, patent consultation, national merit certificates, and cash prize disbursements.



TWO WAYS TO COMPETE

Competition *Tracks*

Two tracks, each with its own expectations for build maturity and presentation format.

Product *Track*

TRACK 01

Working products you can demo — operational ventures, software/hardware products, or commercial business models.

"For projects and products ready to transition into real-world ventures."

TEAM SIZE
1 — 6 members
Solo participation allowed

MATURITY
TRL 5 — 7
Operational venture or working product ready for practical demonstration

FORMAT
Pitch & walkthrough
Live online qualifier pitch, then on-campus closed-door pitch to investors & jury

3 STRATEGIC THEMES

01 **Digital & Software Ventures:** SaaS, FinTech, EdTech, mobile apps, digital platforms.

02 **Smart Systems & Hardware:** Robotics, IoT systems, consumer electronics, physical devices.

03 **Open Innovation:** Unconventional business models, novel services, cross-domain products.

WHAT YOU GET

- Investor pitch access — angels, venture funds & ecosystem partners
- Incubation support at MIT-WPU Innovation Centres
- Mentorship and the next step forward

EVALUATION CRITERIA

01 **Problem & Market Need** — a real problem, a defined target market, and justified demand: market research, problem-solution fit, a defined customer base.

02 **Product & Technical Feasibility** — system architecture, software/hardware stability, engineering quality, overall execution.

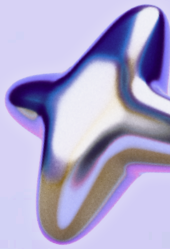
03 **Business Model & Traction** — commercial viability, revenue strategy, scalability, early traction (pilots, metrics, pre-orders).

04 **Competitive Advantage & IP** — uniqueness, IP potential, barriers to entry, differentiation.

05 **Pitch & Jury Q&A** — clarity, communication, handling live technical cross-questioning.

Apply for Product Track →

↓ Download presentation format



Prototype Expo *Track*

TRACK 02



Research and lab builds — academic projects, research builds, functional models, and early-stage technical concepts.

> *"For academic projects, research builds, and early-stage functional models."*

TEAM SIZE
1 — 6 members
Solo participation allowed

MATURITY
TRL 1 — 4
Functional working prototype — hardware build or software model mandatory

FORMAT
Live expo booth
Full-day public exhibition booth on campus & walk-around jury evaluation

3 CORE FOCUS AREAS

01 **Academic Builds & Capstones:** Engineering prototypes, research models, capstone builds, and proof-of-concept implementations.

02 **DeepTech & Hardware Systems:** Robotics, IoT, embedded devices, AgriTech, and healthcare innovations.

03 **Open Software & Social Impact:** High-potential software builds, AI for Bharat, social impact tech, and novel cross-domain projects.

THEMES

AI for Bharat · Healthcare & Accessibility · Education · Sustainability · AgriTech · FinTech · Robotics · Embedded Systems / IoT · DeepTech · Open Innovation

WHAT YOU GET

- Cash prizes, trophies & certificates (1st—3rd) + 3 consolation prizes
- Feedback, exposure & recognition
- Industry connect and mentorship

EVALUATION CRITERIA

01 **Working Prototype & Functionality** — operational stability and execution; smooth live performance and working features score higher.

02 **Innovation & Originality** — fresh, creative applications of technology; unique approaches or novel technical mechanics.

03 **Technical Complexity & Execution** — circuit/system design, code quality, component integration, hardware or software complexity.

04 **Real-World Impact & Practicality** — value to society or industry, and how well the prototype can scale toward production.

05 **Demonstration & Presentation** — clarity of visual and oral presentation, demo flow, and explaining the concept to the jury.

Apply for Prototype Expo Track →

↓ Download presentation format

Need help choosing a track or presentation format?

☎ Call +91 93731 71134 · WhatsApp

WHERE TO BUILD

14 Innovation Domains

Fourteen tech verticals across software and hardware — see where your project aligns with INCUBEX 2026.

</> Software & Digital Innovation

Algorithms, Platforms & Cloud Solutions

01 **AI for Bharat**
Local languages, Indic models, accessibility

02 **Healthcare & Accessibility**
Diagnostics, assistive tools, patient ops

03 **Education & Learning Systems**
Adaptive tutoring, skill assessment, VR labs

04 **Climate, Energy & Sustainability**
Carbon accounting, smart grid telemetry

05 **AgriTech & Food Tech**
Yield modeling, rural livelihoods, supply chain

06 **FinTech & GovTech**
UPI/OCEN innovations, public rails

07 **Peace, Ethics & Social Impact**
Civil safety, conflict mitigation tech

08 **Open Software Innovation**
Developer tools, security & Web3 infra

Hardware & Physical Engineering

Circuits, Robotics & Embedded Builds

09 **Robotics & Drones**
Autonomous rovers, aerial platforms, AGVs

10 **Embedded Systems & IoT**
Edge telemetry, smart sensors, micro-controllers

11 **Manufacturing & Industry 4.0**
Additive manufacturing, digital twins, CNC

12 **DeepTech & Materials**
Optics, biomaterials, quantum devices

13 **Clean Mobility & EV Tech**
BMS, powertrain optimization, smart charging

14 **Open Hardware Innovation**
Novel mechanical & electronic builds

HOW IT WORKS

Event Flow

STAGE 01 · ONLINE

01

Qualifier *Round*

Online PPT submission & live presentation. Registered teams submit their product details using the official PPT template, along with a prototype explanation video and a functional demo link (where applicable). Shortlisted teams then present live in an online pitch session before industry experts and jury members — fully online, so teams across India can take part without travelling.

JUDGED ON

Product Track: market need, product viability, technical feasibility, business potential.
Prototype Track: problem relevance, novelty, working functionality, technical execution.

STAGE 02 · 21 OCT 2026

02

Grand *Finale*

On-site exhibition & pitching. Finalist teams are invited to the MIT-WPU campus for live product pitching, prototype exhibitions, closed-door jury evaluation rounds, and an open exhibition for guests and delegates — with investor pitches and the awards ceremony.

This stage tests technical depth, innovation, clarity of presentation, and readiness for real-world deployment.

- Live booth judging
- Investor pitches
- Awards ceremony

PER TEAM

Participation *Fees*

One registration fee per team.

ALL REGISTERED TEAMS

Initial Registration Fee

₹300 per team

Free registration for MIT-WPU students

One-time fee — no additional charges upon selection for the Grand Finale.

- Covers the whole team (Product: 1—6; Prototype Expo: 1—6 members)
- Entry to the online qualifier round
- Evaluation by the jury panel
- Digital participation certificate for every member

REGISTER YOUR TEAM

incubex.ignisia.tech →

Diploma, UG & PG students from any college across India • free for MIT-WPU teams

PLAY FAIR

Guidelines

TRACK-SPECIFIC RULES

PRODUCT TRACK

Teams of **1 to 6 members**. A functional, working product or service is mandatory. Concepts in the ideation stage without a tangible product are not eligible.

PROTOTYPE EXPO TRACK

Teams of **1 to 6 members**. A functional prototype build (hardware build or software model) is mandatory for live demonstration. Slide-only or purely theoretical concepts are not eligible.

GENERAL RULES — ALL TRACKS

Registration
Each team registers once at incubex.ignisia.tech. Multiple submissions from the same team may lead to disqualification.

Originality of work
All ideas, prototypes, products, and presentations must be the team's original work. Plagiarism or unauthorised IP use leads to immediate disqualification.

Live pitching & online screening
Shortlisted teams present their slides live before the jury in the online screening round and must be physically present for the Grand Finale on campus.

Decision finality
Decisions of the judging panel and organising committee on shortlisting, scores, and awards are final and binding.

Reporting & identification
Carry your college ID and a valid government ID. Event ID passes are issued only after physical ID verification.

Personal equipment
Bring your own laptops, devices, chargers, extension boards, demo apparatus, and personal medicines.

Code of conduct
Professional behaviour, respect, and decorum toward fellow competitors, judges, and volunteers are mandatory. Any misconduct or harassment results in immediate elimination and removal from campus.

Your IP stays yours. 100% IP ownership remains with the participating teams — Ignisia and MIT-WPU do not claim equity, royalties, or code ownership over any participant project.

NEED TO KNOW

Frequently Asked Questions

Answers on eligibility, tracks, registration, and the Grand Finale.

EVENT & ELIGIBILITY

01 What is INCUBEX 2026?

A national-level project expo + launchpad event organised by Ignisia Club at MIT-WPU. It brings together student innovators to showcase working projects, prototypes, and products to expert panels and investors.

02 Who can participate?

College students (Diploma, UG, and PG) from any branch or stream across India. School students are not eligible.

03 What is the age limit?

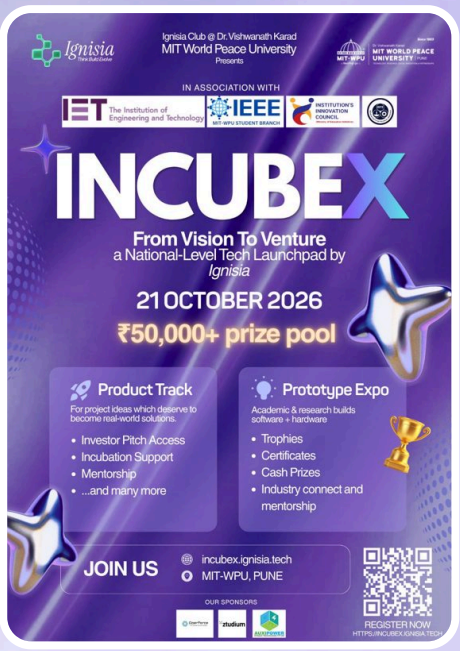
Participants must be between 16 and 22 years old.

04 Can students from outside MIT-WPU participate?

Yes — INCUBEX 2026 is open to students across India. All team members must belong to the same college. Non-MIT-WPU teams pay a one-time fee of ₹300 per team; registration is free for MIT-WPU student teams.

05 What is the event format and when is the finale?

An online evaluation round, followed by an offline Grand Finale at the MIT-WPU campus on 21st October 2026. Only shortlisted finalist teams need to travel.



OFFICIAL POSTER

Scan to register

incubex.ignisia.tech

TRACKS & PROJECT ELIGIBILITY

06 What are the two tracks?

Product Track: operational ventures or working software/hardware products with a business model (TRL 5—7). **Prototype Expo Track:** academic projects, research builds, hardware models, and functional early-stage builds.

07 Can I participate with only an idea or slides?

No. Submissions must have a working implementation or prototype. Purely theoretical concepts or slide-only presentations are not eligible.

08 Can I submit an existing college project, capstone build, or startup?

Yes. Existing academic projects, research builds, capstones, startups, or projects previously entered in other competitions are eligible.

09 Can a team participate in both tracks?

You may submit entries under both tracks, but a team can only be shortlisted for one track in the Grand Finale.

TEAMS & REGISTRATION

10 What are the team size rules?

Product Track: 1 to 6 members. Prototype Expo Track: 1 to 6 members. Solo participation is allowed in both.

11 Can students from different colleges form one team?

No. All team members must be from the same college — but students across different academic years and departments within that college can team up.

12 Can one person join multiple teams?

No, a participant can only be part of one team.

13 How do we register and what is the fee?

The Team Leader registers the team at incubex.ignisia.tech. Free for MIT-WPU teams; ₹300 per team for non-MIT-WPU teams.

14 Can I change team members or registration details after submitting?

No. Team composition, leader details, and track selections cannot be changed after registration.

SELECTION & GRAND FINALE

15 How many teams qualify for the Grand Finale?

80 finalist teams — 30 Product Track and 50 Prototype Expo Track teams — are shortlisted for on-campus booths at the Grand Finale on 21st October 2026.

16 When will shortlisted teams be announced?

Results and finalist announcements are shared after the online evaluation round. Selected teams are notified via email and phone.

17 What is provided at the exhibition booth, and what should teams bring?

Finalists get an assigned exhibition booth with power access on campus. Bring your own laptops, extension boards, chargers, testing devices, and demonstration equipment.

18 Who retains the Intellectual Property (IP) rights?

100% IP ownership remains with the participating teams. Ignisia and MIT-WPU do not claim equity, royalties, or code ownership over any participant project.

Still have questions or need custom clarifications?

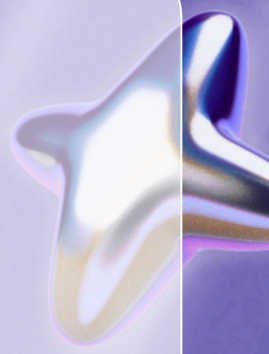
Our organising committee is available to support student innovators.

✉ Email committee | Register Now →

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Dr. Vishwanath Karad
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Your project deserves a *shot.*

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ORGANISING SECRETARIAT

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